their way. The Germans don’t trust us. If we aren’t working, then they think we’re up to no good.”

“But to accuse me of—”

A knock on the door. Léa went to open it. Madame Martin, the owner of the boardinghouse, stood in the corridor, hands crossed at her chest.

“A gentleman came by this evening asking for your sister,” she said.

A terrible kick of a feeling lodged in Rose’s chest—the soldier must have found the sketchbook, tracked her here and was now outside. She hadn’t told Léa about her name and address on the back. She pinched the skin between her thumb and forefinger.

“Who came to see Rose?” Léa asked.

“Don’t play dumb with me.” Raising her voice, she pointed a stubby finger at Rose. “You know the rules. I won’t have men coming here to call on you or any of my boarders. It’s not permitted. That type of behavior leads to trouble, and I don’t want my establishment’s name sullied. Did I not make that clear when you moved in?”

“Yes, you did,” Rose said, pinching her skin harder. “It won’t happen again.”

“It better not. I’m giving you a warning this time, but if another man comes around asking for either of you, then I’ll make sure you’re both gone by the end of the day.”

Léa stiffened. Rose didn’t like the condescension in Madame Martin’s voice either but she felt a sudden sense of relief at the realization that the soldier couldn’t be outside. Madame Martin would have dragged Rose downstairs and handed her over to him. She was always trying to please the Germans. But if he hadn’t come asking after her, then who did?

“Did he give a name?” Rose asked.

“He wouldn’t say.” She made a disapproving click of her tongue before reaching for something out of sight. “He did leave this for you.”

The sketchbook! Rose’s head spun. She thought it was lost forever. “Thank you,” she said, taking it from her.

“Remember—you only get one warning,” Madame Martin said, her voice as sharp as a dagger.

Léa closed the door. “You didn’t tell me you left your sketchbook on the quai.”

Rose sighed. “I meant to. I forgot.”